

Retention Playbook P4 - Dormant Listener Win-Back

When this applies

This playbook targets subscribers who are still paying but are no longer really using the service: `has_activity_60d = 0` (no listening activity in the last 60 days) or a high `recency_days` value (a long gap since the last session). This is a "paying but gone" segment - the churn risk is not about price or plan mechanics, it is that the subscriber has simply stopped getting value from the product and the cancellation is just a matter of time until they notice the charge.

Recency is one of the cleanest signals in the model: subscribers with a long gap since last activity churn at a much higher rate than active listeners, cleanly and monotonically with the size of the gap.

Recommended interventions

Lead with content, not price. A dormant subscriber does not need a discount, they need a reason to open the app again. Send a small number (2-3) of highly personalized re-engagement prompts built from their pre-dormancy listening history ("new releases from artists you used to play") rather than a generic "come back" push notification.

If two re-engagement prompts over consecutive weeks produce no return session, stop the content-led approach and escalate to a win-back offer (a free extended trial period or a one-time discount) framed as "we miss you" rather than "renew now" - the goal at this point is to get one more listening session, not to defend the renewal directly.

Do not run a price-led win-back campaign as the first touch for this segment - it treats a product-fit / relevance problem as a price problem and tends to convert poorly, because a subscriber who has stopped listening was not going to be retained by a lower price on a service they were not using anyway.

Distinguishing from low-engagement (P5)

Dormant (this playbook) means essentially zero activity - the subscriber has functionally left already. Low-engagement (Playbook P5) means the subscriber is still using the service, just thinly (fewer active days, lower listening volume). Sending the P4 "we miss you" win-back message to a P5 subscriber who is still checking in a few times a month reads as tone-deaf and can itself prompt a cancellation; check `has_activity_60d` and `recency_days` before choosing between the two playbooks.